

Asus Zenbook S14

Premium style at a premium price

It is not every day that you get to see a laptop that blends style with substance.

There are plenty of options in the market that look good. And then there are plenty that perform beyond expectations but don't focus much on looks. The Asus Zenbook S14 hits the sweet spot in both aspects. The laptop is just 11.9 mm thick and weighs only 1.2 kilograms. Don't let the size fool you, as the machine is also powered by the Intel Core Ultra 9 386H chipset.

I have been using the Asus Zenbook S14 as my daily driver for more than a week, and with that huge price tag, it might not be for everyone. But, for those who are looking for a top-tier design, a gorgeous display and great performance, this could bring a lot to the table.

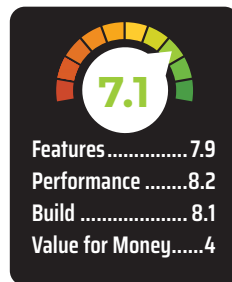
DESIGN AND BUILD

When you're spending this kind of money on a laptop, design isn't just something that you can ignore. It is expected to impress, and the Asus Zenbook S14 gets that right from the start.

Even before you see the laptop, the packaging sets the tone. It's clean, compact, and a reflection of what lies inside. And when you finally lift the lid of this box, the real deal appears.

The Asus Zenbook S14 is one of those devices that makes you go wow the moment you take it out of the box. My first words when I looked at the laptop were 'Hello, gorgeous.' Because honestly, it really is. The overall look is refined, the texture on the lid is subtle yet noticeable, and the Antrim Grey colour gives it a very business-like look. Nothing about the laptop is loud or

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flashy, yet it will definitely turn heads when you walk into a business meeting.

Then there's the Asus Zenbook branding. It sits firmly right in the centre and doesn't try too hard to get noticed. Which honestly

fits the whole vibe of this laptop perfectly. After all, less is more, right?

The build quality here is top-notch, which is again something you would expect from a Rs 2.5 lakh laptop. Asus is using what it calls a Ceraluminum chassis here, which aims to combine the lightness of aluminium with the durability of ceramic. What you get as a result is a surface that is resistant to scratches and smudges. During my usage, I didn't see any fingerprints form upon the chassis even when I was typing continuously for hours. I also remember accidentally placing the laptop in the same pocket as my home keys in my bag. But when I took it out, there were no scratches found.

And one of the major highlights here is the weight and slim form factor.

The laptop is just about 1.1 cm thin and weighs roughly 1.2 kilos. You can just slip this into your bag and forget it's even there. I certainly did.

The only complaint, and I am really nitpicking here, is that when you open the laptop hurriedly with one finger, in a hurry, the bottom part lifts. So, most times, I did need to use both my hands to open the machine. Either it's the problem of the hinge here, or it has to do something with the weight distribution, but this is kind of annoying.

DISPLAY

Lifting the lid, you get a beautiful 14-inch 3K OLED panel. I watched videos, played some casual games, and the display didn't disappoint.

For my daily tasks, the 120Hz refresh rate kept things snappy and smooth.

In terms of colour accuracy as well, the display is spot on as it comes with 100 per cent sRGB and DCI P3 colour space coverage. So, if you're someone who deals with visual content a lot, this is a reliable display.

It is also quite bright at a peak brightness of 1,100 nits. I used the laptop in various light settings without any major hiccups. However, one thing that did bother me was the reflections, which are a common issue in glossy OLED displays. Also, this is a touch-screen display on the Zenbook S14, which is something I didn't find myself using much. And since the display gathers fingerprints and smudges quite easily, I just stuck to using the trackpad and keyboard most of the time.

KEYBOARD AND SPEAKERS

Now, once you actually start using any laptop, the keyboard is something you interact with a lot. And the Zenbook S14 comes with a keyboard that checks all boxes. The keys are well spaced, have a decent amount of travel, and are super comfortable to type on. I do feel a fingerprint sensor should've made the cut. For a laptop, at this price point, it's not only